Nikhil Dixit

Product & Strategy Leader | AI | 0-to-1

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Summary

Product and Strategy Leader with 11+ years across EdTech, Government and Manufacturing. Own strategy and roadmap for upGrad's AI product portfolio, contributing **~30% of company revenue**, and launched four AI products as the market moved from MLOps to Agentic AI. Build hands-on: designed and coded **Pulse**, an LLM-powered customer intelligence platform. Conducted **130+ user and stakeholder interviews** to uncover problems, validate assumptions and shape product and business decisions.

Core Skills

Product: Product Strategy, Roadmap and Prioritisation, 0-to-1 Launches, PRDs, User Research, Market & Competitive Analysis, Product Analytics, A/B Testing

Strategy & Execution: Business Strategy, GTM, Cross-functional Leadership, Executive Stakeholder Management, Revenue-linked Portfolio Ownership, Vendor and Partner Management

Technical: Generative AI, Large Language Models (LLMs), LLM Evaluation, Agentic AI, MLOps, Python, SQL (MySQL), REST/GraphQL APIs, Streamlit, Prompt Engineering, Tableau, Figma

Experience

Senior Program Manager - AI and ML Products — **Bengaluru, India**
upGrad Education Pvt. Ltd. — Aug 2020 - Present

- Own product and business strategy, roadmap and prioritisation for upGrad's AI and ML portfolio, contributing **~30% of company revenue**
- Launched four AI products timed to market shifts: MLOps (2022, **+20–30%** enrolments), GenAI (2023, **~150%** enrolment growth), GenAI for Leaders (2024, new executive segment) and Agentic AI (2025, **+60%** AI enrolment pool)
- Moved the portfolio from multi-year rebuilds to a **~6-month refresh cycle**, driven by market analysis and **80+** in-depth user and subject-matter-expert interviews
- Self-initiated and built **Pulse** end to end (product, design and code): an LLM-powered customer intelligence platform unifying 6 data sources, cutting time to a full customer view from **5 hours to 5 minutes**, with **20%** adoption in the first month
- Owned the performance of an in-house **LLM-powered auto-grader**, evaluating it across all assignment types to **88%** agreement with human graders; **70%** of submissions now auto-graded, grading costs down **80%**, turnaround cut from **14 to 4 days**
- Lifted learner adoption by **15%** by launching an in-browser Python/SQL console that removed local-setup friction
- Led **50+** cross-functional stakeholders across engineering, design, marketing, partnerships and support on one roadmap

Project Manager — **Mumbai, India**
Government of Maharashtra — Sep 2017 - May 2020

- Saved **INR 40 million** annually by redesigning Mumbai's online construction-permit journey using research with **50+** applicants and seven government departments
- Managed **INR 300 million** in livelihood programmes across two districts and structured **INR 20 million** in public-private partnerships creating **500** livelihoods

Product Manager — **Pune, India**
Kalyani Forge Ltd. — Jun 2014 - Dec 2016

- Owned **INR 150 million** IC-engine component portfolio and roadmap; won **INR 10 million** annual worth of international partnership with a French automobile company through a new market-entry strategy

Education and Certifications

Bachelor of Engineering, University of Pune — 2011 - 2014
Project Management Professional (PMP), PMI, USA — 2019